

WORK SAMPLE · ATTRIBUTION PRACTICE · HCM SOFTWARE

Marketing was already tied to revenue.

The CRM was understating it.

I ran the marketing programme at an HCM software company and rebuilt its attribution layer from the CRM up. The layer did not just measure the work — it recovered revenue the business could not see it had earned.

\$162K

CLOSED-WON
ATTRIBUTABLE

\$2.19M

OPEN PIPELINE
SUPPORTED

\$3.22M

OPPORTUNITY
HISTORY TOUCHED

1,479

DEALS AUDITED
TO BUILD IT

Dillon Mohr · AI Marketing Director · Prepared 9 September 2026

Credit window 26 January – 15 July 2026 · HubSpot CRM, no paid media

THE PROOF CASE

One deal, one unbroken path, start to finish.

Most marketing attribution collapses at the join between a click and a closed deal. This one holds all the way through — and it runs through a blog post I wrote.

Weissman — SmartCare 2026 Optimization

DIRECT OWNED-CHANNEL Closed Won · **\$54,000**

Google Organic → Align blog post → qualified form → website-sourced deal → Closed Won

Recorded in the ledger as the **strongest end-to-end organic search proof case** in the portfolio. Organic search brought the buyer in, owned content held them, the form captured them, and the CRM closed them.

And a second, on the CRM's own evidence

Leyad — SmartCare

CRM-CONFIRMED WEBSITE SOURCE Closed Won · **\$108,000**

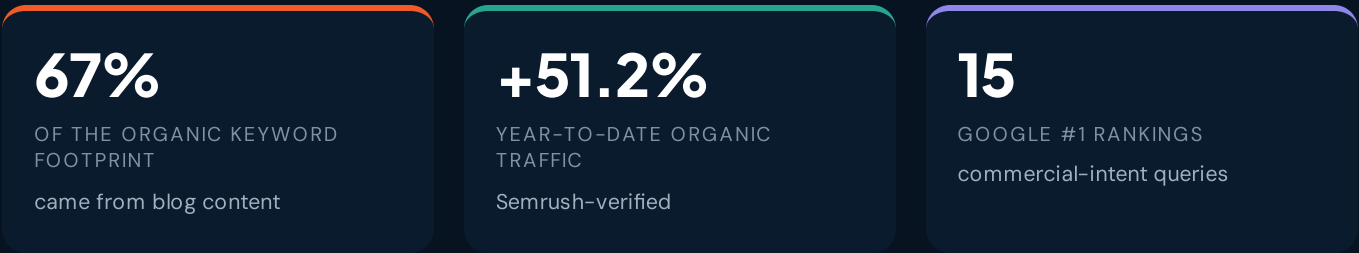
HubSpot records the deal source as Website. The full person-level journey is absent, so the CRM's own source field carries the evidence rather than a reconstructed path. Stated that way deliberately — the tier is part of the claim.

Open pipeline the owned channel put there

OPPORTUNITY	EVIDENCE	AMOUNT
Eat'n Park Restaurants UTA to Pro WFM	Qualified website form, website deal source, eight pageviews	\$400,000
Sienna Senior Living SmartCare 2026	CRM-confirmed website source	\$60,000
Hemlo Mining SmartCare	CRM-confirmed website source	\$50,000
RPM xConstruction SmartCare Services 2026	Google Organic → UKG partner page → qualified form → associated deal	\$15,000
LINKEDIN ASSISTED Ryan Schantz — three open Dayforce opportunities		\$1,662,000
Supported open pipeline		\$2,187,000

The blogs are the footprint.

The organic programme was content I planned, wrote and optimised. It is not a supporting channel in this account — it is the majority of the visibility.



By the July reporting window the footprint had grown to **436 ranking positions across 362 queries and 58 URLs. 211 of those positions — roughly half the entire portfolio — sit on blog pages**, including 17 in the top three. The programme also earned **11 AI Overview placements**.

Queries holding position one

data conversion migration · implementing workday · paychex vs paylocity · uk gpro implementation partner · align hcm

These are buying-stage comparison and vendor-selection queries, not brand defence. A company evaluating an HCM platform is the exact person typing them.

The behaviour changed, not just the traffic

SIGNAL	CHANGE	WHAT IT MEANS
Pages per visit	+139.8%	Visitors going deeper — the content answered the first question and earned the second
Bounce rate	-69.9%	Arrivals matched intent; the ranking was for the right query
Keyword footprint	+9.9%	Breadth of queries the site can win
Referring domains	+9.9%	Earned links, no paid placement

The engagement numbers are the ones worth pausing on. Traffic can be bought. A **139.8% rise in pages per visit alongside a 69.9% fall in bounce rate** is the signature of content matched to real intent, and it was achieved with **no paid media at all**.

HOW IT WAS BUILT

The attribution layer itself.

The reason these numbers exist is that I rebuilt the measurement, not just the marketing. The CRM could not answer the question when I arrived.

STAGE	VOLUME	WHAT HAPPENED
HubSpot deals reviewed	1,479	Full portfolio, not a sample
Reduced to relevant	259	Scoped to the credit window and marketing-reachable deals
Contacts / companies joined	204 / 194	Person-level joins rebuilt where the CRM had none
Forms instrumented	9	85 submissions captured since 26 January
Qualified buyer leads identified	22	Graded by evidence tier, not asserted

Every claim carries its evidence tier.

Direct owned-channel, CRM-confirmed source, and assisted are separated and labelled rather than blended into one headline number. That is what makes the \$162,000 defensible in a room with a CFO in it — the tier travels with the figure.

Then it found something nobody was looking for

22

QUALIFIED BUYER LEADS

59%

HAD LOGGED FOLLOW-UP

7

HOT LEADS NEVER WORKED

Nine qualified buyers had no logged follow-up at all, and seven of those were hot. Marketing had produced them and the business never touched them. Including the highest-scoring lead in the entire cohort — a buyer whose path from an AI assistant to a conversion was captured end to end, at a moment when almost nobody had that instrumented.

That finding is worth more than the revenue number. An attribution layer that only flatters the marketing team is a reporting tool. One that surfaces a 41% follow-up gap is an operating instrument — and it changed what the business did next.

The same problem, one industry over.

This was HCM software sold to HR and finance buyers through a partner-heavy channel. The measurement problem in that market is structural, and it is the same one everywhere.

What the pipeline actually looks like in this space

LEAD SOURCE	DEALS	OPEN PIPELINE
UKG sales rep	18	\$7,908,224
Dayforce sales rep	12	\$6,104,200
Existing client	10	\$1,021,185
Website	3	\$510,000
Word of mouth	3	\$163,000

Partner-sourced pipeline dwarfs everything else, which is exactly why owned-channel contribution gets dismissed in this industry — it looks small next to a reseller relationship. **The website line only becomes an argument when someone can trace it deal by deal.** That tracing is the work.

What I would do in the first ninety days

- **Establish the evidence tiers before the dashboard.** Agree what counts as direct, assisted and correlated, in writing, with sales and finance. Every attribution argument that fails, fails here first.
- **Instrument the AI-assistant path deliberately.** Buyers now arrive from ChatGPT, Perplexity and AI Overviews carrying real intent. Most CRMs file them as Direct and lose them. Recovering that traffic from Direct was one of the highest-value things this layer did.
- **Publish the follow-up coverage number alongside the lead number.** A lead nobody calls is not a marketing win. Reporting both is what made this credible internally.
- **Write the content that owns the comparison queries.** Vendor-selection and migration terms are where the buying decision happens, and they are winnable without paid media — 67% of this footprint came from blog content.

The short version. I built the marketing programme, then built the ledger that proved what it was worth — \$162,000 closed-won and \$2.19M in supported open pipeline — and the same ledger showed the business it was dropping qualified buyers on the floor. I would rather bring both halves of that than only the flattering one.

